

40 nm GPUs

have been used in the new Radeon HD 4770 cards

GA-GC230D

the motherboard from Gigabyte with inbuilt Atom 230 processor

TRIED & TESTED

Dell Studio XPS 13

13.3" with all muscle

The Dell Studio XPS 13 is a nice sleek and stylish 13.3" screen laptop.

It's a fusion of leather, aluminium and plastic – these are the three materials that are present on the back of the lid. When you start this laptop the first thing that we liked is the way the touch buttons light up, then you will also see the backlit keyboard. Having backlight for the keys is a big plus point. Along with that the keys on the keyboard are well separated with pseudo key spacing. Not only do the keys have backlight, but the mouse buttons of the trackpad also do, and the buttons are a joy to press. Though the trackpad is smooth and accurate, it is slightly small.

A few features of this laptop that we didn't quite like are the thickness and weight. We find this laptop to be too thick for 13.3 inch screen and also it is slightly on the heavier side weighing in at 2.2 kgs.

Looking at the sides of the laptop we found some interesting ports. There is a USB-eSATA combined port on the right, a DisplayPort and an HDMI port on the left, and instead of the regular single headphone and microphone ports, there are two 3.5 mm ports for headphones accompanied by a single microphone port. The optical drive on this laptop is the slot loading kind.

The screen of this laptop is really something to talk about; it has really great viewing angles as you can sit on the side and still view a clear picture. The inbuilt speakers are decent, nothing out of the ordinary, but just a slightly better than average.

This motherboard has an Nvidia MCP79MX chipset and also a GeForce 9400M graphics solution which work together in Hybrid SLI. Stacked up with 2 GB DDR3 memory, it is a really good performer.

The battery that came along with this laptop was a 4-cell battery and it lasted for a total of 1 hour and 25 minutes under performance mode of Hybrid SLI – this is what we expected from a 4-cell battery.

If you are willing to look past the exterior, the Dell Studio XPS 13 is a good buy. The model we received costs Rs. 59,900 and is definitely a good performer with the configuration that was present, but the price will vary according to the hardware you select.

Specifications:

Dimensions (W x H x D): 319 x 22.55 x 236.12 mm, Weight: 2.2 kgs, Processor: Intel Core 2



Duo P8400 @ 2.2 GHz, 2 GB DDR3 1066 MHz, 320 GB HDD, 2.0 MP Integrated Webcam

Ratings

Features: 8
Performance: 8.5
Build quality: 7
Value for money: 7
Overall: 7.5

Contact: Dell India
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E-mail: dell_enquiries@dell.com
Web site: www.dell.co.in
Price: Rs. 59,900

ASUS P565

Another Windows Mobile

This phone is definitely stylish and has looks that would attract anybody. Most of the rear cover is made of leather which gives a nice finish to the phone. The front of the phone sports a 2.8-inch VGA display and the body is glossy black in colour. The phone is light as it weighs only 120 grams. The buttons, located below the display are well placed and easy-to-use making them quite ergonomic. Except for the call accept, reject, the quick menu and OK buttons, the other navigation buttons can be customized to lead you to a specific menu.

The ASUS P565 is built on Windows Mobile 6.1, but with ASUS' Glide features you should be able to scroll and perform tasks such as zoom and scroll with just flicks of the finger. However, the phone was quite slow and the Glide feature was laggy. This phone is supposed to have the fastest processor – Marvell PXA930 800 MHz – but it did not seem to be fast at all.

For messaging or typing anything on this phone, you need to use the stylus – it's not very comfortable for on-the-go



typing. Alternatively, you can also use your own handwriting to enter messages and this works brilliantly. Much better than the Nokia 5800 XpressMusic we tested last month.

The call quality is clear and audible on

both ends of a call, but when you use the loudspeaker, the microphone picks up a lot of ambient noise, which is a draw back. The speaker is good enough when consider that this is on a mobile phone.

Overall, the phone does have its charms but it does not come without its faults either. But even so, the price tag of Rs. 21,900 is not justified for this phone and we would not advise you to pay this much.

Specifications:

Form Factor: Bar type, Operating System: Windows Mobile 6.1 Professional, Dimensions: 102 x 60.5 x 16 mm, Display: 2.8" VGA 480 x 640 / 65K / TFT

Ratings

Features: 7
Performance: 6
Build quality: 7
Value for money: 6
Overall: 6.5

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Price: Rs. 21,900